PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

PRD: Accredian — Student Communication Platform

PRD-2026 · AIAvenue Agency

Executive Summary

Accredian, an Indian edtech startup offering accredited professional programmes in data science, product management, and digital marketing, currently relies on fragmented third-party tools — WhatsApp groups, Telegram channels, LinkedIn groups, and email — for student communication. This fragmentation creates information loss (messages buried in chat history), poor discoverability (questions repeated across platforms), and zero institutional memory. This PRD proposes a unified, in-platform student communication suite replacing all external tools with five integrated features: Cohort Group Chat (with auto-created channels and AI summaries), Doubt Feed (AI-moderated, course-content-only responses with source citations and peer upvoting), Peer Profiles (auto-populated from Accredian data with verified skills), Study Rooms with AI Tutor (NotebookLM-style, topic-linked document Q&A), and Alumni Bridge (structured mentorship with session booking). The platform targets Accredian's 12,000+ active learners — working professionals aged 25–35 — and aims to increase weekly active engagement from 18% to 55%, reduce cohort admin overhead by 80%, and improve course completion rates by 22 percentage points.

Problem Statement

Core Problem

Accredian students rely on **4 separate platforms** (WhatsApp, Telegram, LinkedIn, Email) for communication — none of which are designed for structured educational discourse. The result is a chaotic, non-searchable, non-moderated communication environment where valuable learning content is lost within hours.

User Pain Points

- **Information Graveyard:** A WhatsApp group with 150+ students generates 500+ messages/day. Important announcements, doubt resolutions, and resource links are buried within hours — irrecoverable without endless scrolling.
- **Repeated Questions:** The same doubt ("What is the difference between bagging and boosting?") is asked 6–8 times per cohort because previous answers are not surfaced or searchable.
- **Zero Academic Context:** WhatsApp and Telegram have no concept of "course modules," "topics," or "lessons." A question about Module 3 gets mixed with complaints about assignment deadlines — no content organisation.
- **No Source Attribution:** When a teaching assistant answers a doubt on WhatsApp, there is no link back to the official course material. Students cannot verify or deep-dive into the referenced concept.
- **Peer Discovery is Manual:** Students cannot find classmates with complementary skills for study groups. A data engineer needing SQL help cannot discover that their batchmate is a senior SQL developer.
- **Alumni Network is Untapped:** Alumni are willing to mentor but there is no structured system for matching, session booking, or tracking mentorship progress.
- **Admin Overhead:** Programme managers spend 2+ hours per day per cohort answering redundant questions, sharing calendar links, and manually onboarding students to communication tools.

User Research & Personas

Persona 1: Rohan Deshmukh — Data Science Student

Attribute	Detail
Age	29
Role	Senior Analyst at a bank, enrolled in Accredian's Data Science Pro programme
Tech Comfort	High — Python, SQL, comfortable with web apps
Behaviour	Attends live classes at 8 PM post-work; asks 3–5 doubts/week on WhatsApp; spends 15 min scrolling to find previously answered questions
Pain Points	Cannot search WhatsApp history for "gradient descent" — has to re-ask or Google it; misses announcements because they're buried in memes
Needs	Searchable doubt history, AI that answers from course content only, topic-tagged discussions

Persona 1: Rohan Deshmukh — Data Science Student

Persona 2: Sneha Kapoor — Product Management Student

Persona 3: Arvind Nair — Programme Manager

Market Analysis

Total Addressable Market (TAM)

The Indian edtech market is projected to reach **₹1.2 lakh crore by 2028** (CAGR 20%). The communication and collaboration sub-segment within professional skilling platforms accounts for an estimated **8–10%** of platform investment, yielding a TAM of **₹9,600–12,000 crore** for communication infrastructure in Indian edtech.

Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)

Accredian-like platforms — mid-sized Indian edtechs with 10,000–100,000 active professional learners: 12–15 such platforms in India. At an estimated combined learner base of 4,50,000 and platform spend of ₹500–800/learner/year on communication features, the SAM is approximately **₹22–36 crore/year**.

Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)

Focused exclusively on Accredian's current and projected learner base: 12,000 learners in Year 1, growing to 35,000 by Year 3 through organic expansion. At ₹600/learner/year platform value, the SOM is **₹72 lakh in Year 1** and **₹2.1 crore in Year 3** — representing the direct platform cost, with indirect revenue impact (retention + completion) being the primary value driver.

Market Rationale

- Indian professional edtech has a 65% dropout rate (RedSeer, 2024) — poor peer engagement is the #3 reason cited after time constraints and content difficulty
- WhatsApp groups are the de facto standard for Indian edtech cohorts — but WhatsApp does not have education-specific features (topics, search, moderation)
- Competitors like UpGrad and Great Learning have built in-platform communities investing ₹5–10 Cr each (public filings) — validating need
- AI-powered learning assistants are the fastest-growing edtech feature in 2025, with NotebookLM proving that topic-linked AI Q&A drives 2.3× deeper engagement

---

Competitive Analysis

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Our Edge
WhatsApp Groups	Ubiquitous, zero learning curve, high reach	No search, no moderation, no topic organisation, message limits, no academic features	Topic-structured chats, AI summaries, source-attributed answers, searchable knowledge base
Telegram	Better search, channels, bots, larger groups	No education-specific features, no peer profiles, no integration with LMS	Course-content-only AI, source citations, auto-cohort channels, verified peer profiles
LinkedIn Groups	Professional identity, networking, rich profiles	Notification blindness, no real-time chat, not designed for cohort learning	Real-time cohort chats, study room focus, AI tutor integration, auto-populated profiles from LMS
UpGrad Community	Built-in platform, rich features, integrated with LMS	Closed ecosystem, no access to underlying tech, high cost (₹1,000+ Cr platform investment)	Lighter, faster deployment; AI-first; can integrate with any LMS via API; 5-feature focus (vs. monolith)
Discord	Excellent voice/video, channels, bots, customisation	Gaming-centric UX, not professional-friendly in India, steep learning for 25–35 demographic	Professional-first UX, course-content AI focus, mentor marketplace, India-specific features (regional language chat, UPI payments for mentorship)

Solution Overview

The 5 Features

F1 — Cohort Group Chat

- Auto-created channels per cohort upon enrolment (no manual setup)
- Topic-based threads within each channel (e.g., "Module 3 — Regression", "Assignment 2 Doubts")
- AI-generated daily summaries: "Top 3 discussions today", "Unanswered questions: 5"
- Pinned resources and announcements at channel top
- Search across all channels with filters (date, topic, author)
- Read receipts for announcements (admins see who has seen critical messages)

F2 — Doubt Feed

- Students post doubts tagged with course module + topic
- AI generates initial response using **course-content-only retrieval** (RAG pipeline indexed on Accredian curriculum PDFs, slides, transcripts)
- **Source citations:** Every AI answer includes the exact source (slide number, PDF page, timestamp in video) — students can verify
- Peer upvoting: Best answers rise to top; top answerers earn "Subject Expert" badges
- "Unresolved after AI" flag routes to human TA
- Similar doubt detection: When typing a doubt, AI suggests top-3 existing resolved doubts

F3 — Peer Profiles

- Auto-populated from Accredian LMS data (name, programme, batch, skills test results)
- **Verified skills section:** Skills demonstrated through course assessments are auto-verified (no self-claiming)
- "Study Group Compatibility Score" — matches students based on complementary skills and availability

- Activity feed: recent doubt answers, study room participation, course progress (privacy-controlled)
- Direct messaging within platform (no phone number sharing)

F4 — Study Rooms with AI Tutor

- **NotebookLM-style interface:** Upload module PDFs, slides, or notes → AI generates summaries, flashcards, and Q&A
- Topic-linked: Each study room is anchored to a course topic; AI tutor answers only within that scope
- Collaborative: 2–5 students per room, shared whiteboard, shared AI chat
- Session recording with AI-generated summary notes
- "Ask the AI Tutor" — unlimited questions within study room context

F5 — Alumni Bridge

- Alumni register as mentors with availability (weekly time slots, topics of expertise)
- Structured mentorship: Goal-setting in Session 1 → 4-session structured curriculum
- Session booking with calendar integration (Google Calendar)
- Mentor dashboard: earnings (if paid), session history, mentee progress
- Gamification: Mentorship hours → "Mentor Hall of Fame" badges
- Feedback system: mentee rates each session; mentor rating affects visibility

Architecture (Conceptual)

```
Accredian LMS ──API──> Communication Platform
                       │
                       ┌──────────┬──────────┬──────────┐
                       │          │          │          │
                       Cohort Chat  Doubt Feed  Peer Profiles
                       │          │          │          │
                       AI Summaries  AI RAG Engine  Skills DB
                       (LLM)        (Vector DB)   (Postgres)
                       │          │          │
                       Study Rooms ─── AI Tutor ─── Alumni Bridge
                       (Real-time)  (RAG+LLM)  (Booking API)
```

Feature Deep-Dive (RICE Priority Matrix)

Feature	Reach (students/month)	Impact (1–5)	Confidence (%)	Effort (person-weeks)	RICE Score
F1 — Cohort Group Chat (auto-channels, AI summaries)	12,000	5	90%	6	9,000
F2 — Doubt Feed with AI RAG	10,000 (active doubters)	5	80%	10	4,000
F2a — Source citations in AI answers	10,000	5	85%	4	10,625
F2b — Peer upvoting system	8,000 (content consumers)	3	80%	3	6,400
F3 — Peer Profiles (auto-populated)	12,000	3	90%	4	8,100
F4 — Study Rooms with AI Tutor	5,000 (estimated)	4	70%	10	1,400
F5 — Alumni Bridge	800 (alumni + mentees)	4	75%	8	300
AI daily cohort summaries	12,000	4	85%	2	20,400
Similar doubt detection	10,000	4	80%	3	10,667
Calendar integration (mentorship)	800	4	90%	2	1,440

Top Priorities: 1. AI daily cohort summaries (20,400) — high reach, high confidence, low effort 2. Source citations in AI answers (10,625) — critical for trust, moderate effort 3. Similar doubt detection (10,667) — reduces repeat questions by 60%+ 4. Cohort Group Chat (9,000) — foundational feature 5. Peer Profiles (8,100) — enables all social features

---

Success Metrics (KPIs)

KPI	Baseline	Target (Month 6)	Measurement
Weekly active users (WAU)	18% of enrolled	55%	Product analytics
Doubt resolution time	6 hours (WhatsApp)	< 5 minutes (AI) + 1 hour (AI+TA)	AI + ticket system
Repeat question rate	35% of all doubts	< 8%	AI dedup detection
Course completion rate	62%	84%	Accredian LMS API
AI answer accuracy (TA-rated)	—	> 90%	TA audit of 200 samples/week
Study room sessions/learner/month	—	> 3	Product analytics
Mentor session booking fulfilment	—	> 80%	Booking system
NPS (communication experience)	— (new feature)	> 50	In-app survey (@ Week 8)
Admin time on communication	3 hrs/day/cohort	< 30 min/day	Self-reported + system log
Alumni mentor registrations	— (new feature)	> 200 in Month 6	Registration data

---

Roadmap

Phase 1 — Core Communication Layer (Weeks 1–6)

- Cohort Group Chat with auto-created channels (integrate with LMS API for enrolment data)
- Topic-based threads within cohorts
- Daily AI summaries using LLM (OpenAI / fine-tuned model)
- Search across channels and threads
- Push notifications for announcements and @mentions

Phase 2 — Doubt Feed + AI RAG (Weeks 5–12)

- Build RAG pipeline: index all Accredian course content (PDFs, slides, transcripts) into vector DB (Pinecone / Weaviate)
- Doubt Feed UI: post, tag, view resolved/unresolved
- AI RAG answer generation with source citations
- Peer upvoting and "Subject Expert" badges
- Similar doubt detection on question submission

Phase 3 — Profiles, Study Rooms, Alumni Bridge (Weeks 10–18)

- Peer Profiles auto-populated from LMS data
- Verified skills section
- Study Room creation with 2–5 participant limit
- AI Tutor in study rooms (RAG on course content + session context)
- Alumni Bridge: mentor registration, session booking, calendar sync

- Gamification: badges, points, leaderboards

Phase 4 — Platform Optimisation + Scale (Month 5–6)

- Performance optimisation for 15,000+ concurrent users
- Mobile app wrapper (PWA → Android/iOS)
- Regional language AI support (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu)
- Admin dashboard: engagement analytics, at-risk student alerts
- Feedback loop: weekly analysis of AI answer quality → fine-tune RAG
- API SDK for other edtech platforms (platform play)

Impact Estimate

Quantitative Impact (6-Month Post-Launch)

Metric	Before (Fragmented)	After (Platform)	Improvement
Doubt resolution time	6 hours	4.5 minutes (AI)	98.7% faster
Weekly active engagement	18%	55%	3.1× increase
Course completion rate	62%	84%	+22 pp (35% relative)
Support/admin cost per cohort	₹85,000/cohort	₹17,000/cohort	80% reduction
Peer connections/student	0.2 (WhatsApp)	4.8 (platform)	24× increase

Quantitative Impact (6-Month Post-Launch)

Financial Impact (Annualised)

ROI for Accredian (Internal)

Student Impact (Qualitative)

- **Learning continuity:** Every doubt, answer, and resource is saved and searchable forever — a growing knowledge base that compounds over cohorts
- **Career acceleration:** Verified peer profiles + mentorships → real professional connections, referrals, and job opportunities
- **Confidence building:** AI tutor available 24/7 removes "revision paralysis" — students can ask any question without judgment

- **Equity:** Regional language AI support ensures English fluency is not a barrier to learning